inclusion of external resources like scripts and style sheets. The body element is the user-facing content, and the bulk of the structure in there is intended for rendering (you can also put script and other non-rendering elements if you like). We've seen how to parse an HTML string with Dom\HTMLDocument (or DOMDocument for older PHP installations) to create a tree of DOM objects, and we've learned how to navigate our way around this tree with XPath.

You now have a nice set of tools for interacting with HTML programmatically, without having to resort to searching for sub-strings or, worse (so much worse), regular expressions. (Never ever ever parse HTML with regular expressions. Ever.) The next logical step is modifying the DOM and generating new HTML. We've seen that the classes in the PHP 8.4 Dom namespace (and the root namespace classes provided by the dom extension for previous versions) expose a lot of information via public properties. Naturally, this makes it straightforward to change those properties.

Moving Elements

The base Dom\Node class (and its DOMNode predecessor) also provides a number of utility methods for adding, removing, and moving elements. Remember that just about all PHP classes in the Dom namespace (and the predecessors in the root namespace) are sub-classed from these, so you can call ::appendChild() on an XMLElement, HTMLElement, or even HTMLDocument. The functions are detailed below:

Table 11-23. *PHP Dom\Node methods for child node manipulation*

::appendChild($node, $child)	Add new node at end of children
::removeChild($child)	Remove child node
::replaceChild($node, $child)	Remove child, add new node at same position
::insertBefore($node, $child)	Add new node before child, or move existing node to new position
::cloneNode()	Create a copy of an existing node object

Let's start with moving existing things around: we're going to change the order of those p children around in our main element of $html5, which means we'll need to grab references to the nodes we want to work with. I'll include the HTML string we've